

Niklas Hlubek

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Epidemiologist & Interdisciplinary Researcher with expertise across **health sciences, psychology, and environmental studies**. I analyze **large-scale datasets** using advanced statistical and causal methods, integrating health, behavioral, and geospatial data. Experienced in building memory-efficient pipelines, developing interactive visualizations, and translating complex evidence into clear, actionable insights for diverse audiences.

EDUCATION

- PhD. **Epidemiology**, Utrecht University, Utrecht - NL, expected early 2026
MSc. **Social Policy and Public Health**, Utrecht University, Utrecht - NL, 2022
MSc. **Psychological Research**, University of Edinburgh, Edinburgh - SCO , 2021
BSc. **Psychology**, Erasmus University Rotterdam, Rotterdam - NL, 2019

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

- 2023 - 25 **Doctoral Research Fellow** - University Medical Center Utrecht - NL
Project: *Longitudinal socioeconomic disparities in environmental health associations*
- Designed and executed advanced quantitative analyses on longitudinal registry cohort data (>70M observations) to investigate socioeconomic patterns in environmental health inequalities
- Independently developed and implemented comprehensive data linkage pipelines integrating multiple registry and environmental data sources, establishing robust harmonization protocols and quality assurance frameworks
- Authored peer-reviewed manuscripts (2 published, 2 under review) and presented findings at international conferences to academic and policy audiences
- 2024 **Research Consultant** - Municipality Utrecht, Utrecht - NL
- Delivered evidence-based case report on city-level environmental inequalities for policy stakeholders
- 2024 **Visiting Researcher** - ISGlobal Barcelona Institute for Global Health, Barcelona - ESP
- Advanced spatial epidemiology and clustering methodologies for population health research
- Managed the harmonization and analysis of data from 2 longitudinal European cohorts
- 2022 **Policy and Projects Assistant** - Mental Health Europe, Brussels - BE
- Organized co-production workshops with diverse stakeholders and conducted European mental health policy analysis
- 2020 **Research Assistant** - University Medical Center Hamburg Eppendorf, Hamburg - DE
- Supported psychiatric interventions and contributed to clinical research protocols
- 2019 - 20 **Research Assistant** - Max Planck Institute for Cognitive and Brain Sciences, Leipzig - DE
- Supporting research assistant in large double-blind randomized controlled trial

GRANTS

- 2023-25 **Marie Skłodowska-Curie Actions ITN Fellowship**
Full PhD fellowship within EU H2020 project SURREAL (surreal-itn.eu)

TEACHING & INVOLVEMENT

- 2024-25 **PhD Council Board Member**, Julius Center, University Medical Center Utrecht
- Representative responsible for communication between PhD candidates and Division Leadership
- 2023-25 **Teaching Assistant**, Evidence Based Case Reports, Utrecht University Medical Center
- Led interactive tutorials on systematic literature search methods for medical students

PUBLICATIONS

- 2025 **Hlubek, N.**, , Koop Y., Verhoeven J., Wagtendonk A., Vienneau D., Vaartjes I., “Air pollution and ischemic stroke across socioeconomic groups in the Netherlands” *Science of The Total Environment*. Currently under review
- 2025 **Hlubek, N.**, Koop Y., Wagtendonk A., Vaartjes I. “Area-level temporal trends in air pollution exposure across socioeconomic position groups in the Netherlands” *Health and Place*. Currently under review
- 2025 **Hlubek, N.**, Gehring, U., J. Boer et al. “Assessing the impact of changes in home location on adolescent lung function: an exposome-wide natural experiment” *Environment International*. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.envres.2025.123132>
- 2024 **Hlubek, N.**, Koop Y., Wagtendonk A., Vaartjes I. “Temporal Trends in Air Pollution Exposure across Socioeconomic Groups in the Netherlands.” *Int. J. Environ. Res. Public Health*. <https://doi.org/10.3390/ijerph21080976..>
- 2022 **Hlubek, N.**, Templeton, A., Wiseman-Gregg, K. “A social identity approach to COVID-19 transmission in hospital settings.” *Journal of Applied Social Psychology*. <https://doi.org/10.1111/jasp.12948>.
- 2022 Bomke P., **Hlubek, N.** “Entwicklung der Sozialpsychiatrie in Europa - die Sicht von Mental Health Europe” *Kerbe - Forum fuer soziale Psuychiatrie*.
- 2021 Moritz S., Xie J., Penney D., Biehl L., **Hlubek, N.**, Elmers J., Beblo T., Hottenrott B. “The magnitude of neurocognitive impairment is overestimated in depression: the role of motivation, debilitating momentary influences, and the overreliance on mean differences.” *Psychological Medicine*. <https://doi.org/10.1017/S0033291721004785>.
- 2020 Jelinek L., **Hlubek, N.**, Moritz S., Miegel F., Voderholzer U. “Zwangsstörungen während COVID-19: Sind Menschen mit Waschzwängen besonders betroffen.” *z-aktuell*.

PRESENTATIONS

- 2025 **Hlubek, N.**, Koop Y., Verhoeven J., Wagtendonk A., Vienneau D., Vaartjes I., “Air pollution and ischemic stroke across socioeconomic groups in the Netherlands” Project presented at the **ESC Preventive Cardiology** Conference, Milano (2025)
- 2025 **Hlubek, N.** “Equity in exposure” Presentation at **UBD Policy Workshop on Equity in Health Impact Assessment** (ubdpolicy.eu), Utrecht (2025)

- 2024 **Hlubek, N.**, et al. “Impact of exposome relocation trajectories on childhood lung function”
Project presented to the annual **EXPANSE meeting**, Munich (2024)
- 2022 Templeton A., **Hlubek, N.** “Social identity processes in hospital workers risk perception and adherence to safety guidance during the COVID-19 pandemic.” Paper presented at the **BPS Social Psychology Section Annual Conference**, Online (2022)
- 2021 **Hlubek, N.**, Templeton A. “A social identity approach to COVID-19 transmissions in hospital settings – Barriers and avenues to safe behavior in healthcare workers.” Project presented to the **Scottish Government COVID-19 Nosocomial Review Group**, Online (2021)

TECHNICAL SKILLS & LANGUAGES

Programming & Tools

R (lme4, lavaan, survival, tidyverse)
SQL, Git/GitHub, Markdown/Quarto

Statistical & Computing

Multilevel modeling
Survival/Time-to-event analysis
Causal Inference (DAGs, Propensity scores)

Data management

ETL Automation, Data Quality Assurance
Registry linkage, Secure Research Environments
GDPR Compliance, Data Pseudonymisation
Memory efficient data handling

Languages

German (native), English (fluent)
Dutch (intermediate, B2)

ADDITIONAL TRAINING & WORKSHOPS

- 2024 **Introduction to Causal Inference and Causal Data Science**
Utrecht Summer School, Utrecht University
- 2024 **Supercomputing for social scientists with R**
ODISSEI Social Data Science Team, SURF Amsterdam
- 2023 **Modern Method in Data Analysis**
Graduate School of Life Sciences, Utrecht University